

My AI Workflow Audit

I do not immediately depend on ChatGPT or Claude when starting a project. My workflow usually begins offline with a notebook, pen, and paper. I first think through the project idea independently and write down the problem, possible solution, and rough implementation approach.

After forming an initial idea, I research whether similar solutions already exist. I use Google Search and also discuss the same idea with multiple AI tools. I use Gemini more often when researching current information because of its integration with the Google ecosystem. For longer technical discussions and iterative project development, I generally use ChatGPT. I primarily use Claude later for frontend and design-related work.

Once my initial thought process is complete, I organize the project idea into a document or PDF. I provide this document to ChatGPT and ask it to identify flaws, missing considerations, and weaknesses in the proposed solution. My goal at this stage is not to generate a new idea but to critically evaluate and improve my existing idea. I also compare the project with existing approaches and look for ways to differentiate or improve it.

After the idea and architecture are finalized, I may ask ChatGPT for starter code. However, I first try to understand the generated code and then write the important code manually, line by line. I avoid directly copying the core implementation because writing it myself helps me understand the logic and architecture.

I usually implement the core functionality as a console-based program first. This allows me to verify that the main idea actually works before adding APIs, frontend components, or other abstractions.

Once the core implementation works, I begin developing the backend and APIs. During this stage, I use ChatGPT collaboratively for small and fragmented parts of the system rather than asking it to generate the entire backend. I have found that generating a complete application at once can introduce unnecessary errors and make debugging more difficult.

After the backend and APIs are working correctly, I use AI more heavily for basic frontend development. I may ask ChatGPT to generate a simple HTML, CSS, and JavaScript interface and use the generated code as a starting point.

When the complete frontend and backend are connected and functional, I provide the project context to Claude and use it to improve the frontend design, visual quality, and interactivity. At this stage, I am more comfortable delegating design-oriented implementation because the underlying system and functionality have already been verified.

For small bugs or mistakes, I generally try to identify and fix the issue myself first. If I cannot find the root cause after investigating the problem, I use AI as a debugging collaborator rather than immediately asking it for a complete replacement solution.

Classification:

My task	Classification
Initial idea thinking	Just me
Writing idea on paper	Just me
Existing-solution research	Collaborate with AI
Current information research	Delegate to AI with review
Finding flaws in your idea	Collaborate with AI
Improving project architecture	Collaborate with AI
Starter code generation	Delegate to AI with review
Writing core code	Just me
Console prototype	Just me
Backend/API development	Collaborate with AI
Basic frontend generation	Delegate to AI with review
UI/design improvement	Delegate to AI with review
Small bug fixing	Just me first